

STUART NEUMANN

Neumann Turns Wreckage Into 44 Points

A quadruple bogey at the 1st suggested more of the same, but by the 6th he had 13 points in four holes and by the 18th his best gross round at this course by five shots.

Stuart Neumann opened his second round at PGA Catalunya Tour with a quadruple-bogey 8 at the 1st. The 1st is stroke index 14, which is to say one of the gentler holes on the property. He took an 8 there regardless.

What followed was less a recovery than a rebuttal. He gained 13 Stableford points across the 3rd to the 6th, capped by a birdie at the 6th that also completed two holes without a gross shot dropped. A second such stretch arrived at the 8th and 9th. The round then threatened to fall over again on 14, 15 and 16, where a double bogey, a triple and

another double cost him seven shots and three points. It was not enough. The card had already gone too far to be argued with.

Neumann signed for 44 points, the best score recorded by anyone in the 2019 TEG Trophy's second round, and top of the field of six by some distance. The day's next-best was 36. It also stood as a course personal best for him at PGA Catalunya, improving his best gross score there this TEG to 93. Gregg Williams retained his lead in both the Trophy and the Green Jacket, untroubled by any of it.

AT A GLANCE
ROUND OF THE DAY Stuart NEUMANN (44 pts)
TROPHY LEAD Gregg WILLIAMS, 1 ahead
GREEN JACKET LEAD Jon BAKER and Gregg WILLIAMS, level

ROUND STABLEFORD
SN 44 GW 42 JP 42 DM 40 AB 37 JB 36
ROUND GROSS
DM +12 GW +16 JB +16 SN +21 AB +24 JP +24

AFTER R2 · TROPHY
GW 88 JP 87 SN 80 JB 76 DM 75 AB 71
AFTER R2 · GREEN JACKET
GW +28 JB +28 DM +29 JP +48 AB +54 SN +54

TROPHY

Williams and Patterson End Where They Began

A quintuple-bogey 10 at the 15th cost John Patterson the lead, he was level again by the 16th, and the gap at close of play was the same single point it had been at dawn.

The TEG 12 Trophy lead moved five times during round two at PGA Catalunya and settled nowhere. John Patterson drew level at the 4th. He took it outright at the 12th, was pegged back to a tie at the 13th, and lost it outright at the 15th. He levelled again at the 16th. He then closed with three straight bogeys worth 3 points each, nine points across the final stretch.

The 15th deserves its own mention. Patterson made a quintuple-bogey 10 on the par 5. It cost him the outright lead and, one suspects, some quiet interior scaffolding. All that movement, and the final margin did not shift by a single point. Gregg Williams ended the round exactly as he had started it, one clear of Patterson.

The Green Jacket behaved much the same way. Williams drew level on gross at the 10th with a birdie, and level again at the 18th with a closing par. The gap stood at zero, as it had all along. By the close of play Williams led both the Trophy and the Jacket, and the table looked precisely as it had that morning. Eighteen holes, six men, considerable exertion, no consequence.

WOODEN SPOON | ALEX BAKER

Eleven Shots in Four Holes

Twelve points through five holes, then double, triple, triple, triple, and a Wooden Spoon deficit that has quietly grown from one point to four.

Alex Baker's second round at PGA Catalunya Tour began promisingly. He picked up 12 Stableford points across the 2nd to the 5th, built on pars at the 2nd and the 5th, with bogeys at the 3rd and the second-hardest hole on the course, the 4th. He was, briefly, playing golf.

Then the 6th. A double bogey there dropped him to the bottom of the TEG 12 Wooden Spoon race, and the bottom proved comfortable. He went four holes without a net par. A triple at the 7th, a triple at the short 8th, a triple at the 9th. Eleven gross shots handed over across those four holes, without any noticeable change in his demeanour.

A birdie at the 10th finally stopped the bleeding. He found another decent spell later too, taking 9 points from the 13th to the 15th, including a bogey at the 13th, the hardest hole on the course. None of it counted for anything where it mattered. He stayed the race's laggard, and the gap to the next-worst player in the field grew from one shot to four. Some men lead from the front. Baker leads from the back, and he is pulling away.

DAVID MULLIN

Four Pars, Then the 9th

An 84 here is one shot better than anything David Mullin had managed on the Tour course before, and it was comfortably the lowest gross round of the day.

David Mullin carded the best gross round of the day on Friday at PGA Catalunya's Tour Course. An 84, and a personal best at the venue, beating his previous mark of 85 by one shot across five visits. Five visits, one shot. The margins of a patient man. The 84 also equalled the Tour Course record, first set by Jon Baker in TEG 11. Gregg Williams and Jon Baker had matched it in round one of this TEG.

The round turned on the 5th to the 8th. Four straight pars, not a gross shot dropped, 12 Stableford points collected, including a par at the 8th, one of the harder holes out there. The run ended at the 9th with a triple bogey and a blank Stableford return. The rest of the card held firm enough to deliver the low gross of the day, which after years of near-misses at this course counts as a debt settled.

RECORDS & PERSONAL BESTS

Notable achievements: TEG 12, Round 2

COURSE RECORDS

— David Mullin's 84 at PGA Catalunya - Tour — equals the course record, set by Jon Baker in TEG 11; 16 earlier rounds there